

Echo of Fate

(Charles' POV)

Life had always been a sum of equations to me. Variables, constants, outcomes—mostly favorable. I was the mathematician of my own existence, solving for "Success" with effortless precision.

But then came the outlier. A singular expression. A stray thought that spilled from my mouth without my control, a confession that crashed the system. And just like that, the equation collapsed.

Now, standing atop this fucking building, the wind whipping against a face I no longer recognize as happy, I realize the truth: this world does not deserve the energy I feed it.

I look down at the city, a sprawling circuit board of meaningless lights, and I don't feel sadness. I feel **negation**. I want to burn every living concept to dust. This cockiness, this unfairness, this "Fate" that dictates a person like me is destined to be unloved—I reject it.

If Fate thinks it can trap me in a tragedy, it's wrong. I will not fall for the sunk-cost fallacy of existence. I will balance the ledger on my own terms.

I stepped off the ledge, leaving behind any hope for a world that had none for me. I fell, not hoping for heaven, but for the silence of zero.

"I choose you."

The voice didn't come from the sky; it came from the fabric of the abyss itself. I was floating in a void darker than death.

"Why me?" I asked, my voice sounding small against the infinite silence. "I am no hero."

"Because to fight the Embodiment of Physical Concepts, I require someone who hates them," the ominous voice resonated, vibrating through my soul. **"You despise the very rules of reality. You are the perfect vessel."**

"Who are you?"

"I am the Creator. The All-Father of this Omni-Omniverse. A cosmology far vaster than your limited mind can render."

"If there are infinite realities," I scoffed, assuming this was the final hallucination of a dying brain, "then choose someone else."

"No," the God replied, his tone shifting from observer to architect. **"Anyone with mana would burn. But you... you have destruction in your soul and a void where mana**

should be. Because you are empty, I can fill you. I will impart one-third of the Archangel of Destruction into your vessel."

"And the price?" I asked. "What do I get for becoming your weapon?"

"I will return you to your universe. I will replace you at the exact moment you died. And perhaps... I will even let you date 'Hope' after all."

Hope. The variable I couldn't solve.

"Alright," I whispered, convinced by the one thing I couldn't have. "But you have to teach me how to use this."

"No," the God said, his voice fading like a dying star. "No one knows how the Archangel of Destruction functions. He is chained because his very existence threatens the code of reality. You must figure it out yourself."

(The world flashes white)

"I MUST SURVIVE!"

Pain. Absolute, searing pain.

My arm wasn't just broken; it was spaghettified. The **Titan of Friction** had flung me with enough force to ignite the atmosphere around my skin. I hit the ground, dust filling my lungs, my body screaming.

(Flash)

I stood over the corpse of the Titan. In its chest pulsed a gem—raw, jagged, and terrifying. It wasn't just a rock; it was the crystallized concept of Friction itself.

I had no mana. I had no spells. I had nothing but hunger.

What if this gem is just another variable?

I didn't think. I opened my bloody mouth and shoved the jagged crystal inside. I bit down. It tasted like shit—like burning rubber and ozone—but as I swallowed, something snapped. A burst of energy exploded from my stomach. My shattered arm knitted itself back together in seconds. The air around me began to hum.

So this was it. The fucking God forgot to give me mana, so I had to eat it from the corpses of his mistakes.

(Flash)

The battlefield was a graveyard of giants.

"I have slain 799 of your kin," I stated, my voice echoing with a power that wasn't mine.
"You, **Titan of Fate**, stand no chance against the man who ate your brethren."

The Titan loomed over me, a shadow made of inevitability. **"Then I shall perish,"** it boomed, its voice weaving into the timeline. **"But I curse you, First Hero. You may conquer reality, but you will never conquer the void. I curse you with Eternal Loneliness."**

(Flash)

"ERROR."

The Angelic voice sounded panicked. **"The Curse has corrupted the targeting parameters. I cannot return you to the moment of your death. The timeline is rejecting you. Sending you to the Past..."**

(Flash)

A portal ripped open the sky.

"With the power of God, I summon the First Hero, the God-Slayer!"

I hit the ground, dust rising around me. It was the Fourth Hero—Défteros. I was back. And this time, the God didn't hesitate. He poured another **third** of the Archangel into me, unlocking the floodgates I had been clawing at for eons.

(Flash)

"SINGULARITY EVENT DETECTED."

God's voice returned, cold and efficient. **"In all other timelines, the variable 'Charlie' has ceased to function. The only remainder is you. I order the merger. All versions of you across the multiverse shall collapse into this singular point."**

I felt them die. Billions of me. Billions of suicides, billions of failures, all rushing into my soul at once.

(Present Day)

"Ahh..."

I opened my eyes, the memories fading into the background static of my mind.

"It's been so long since I had the pleasure of sleeping in a mana-dense place," I groaned, stretching my arms until my joints popped. The air here tasted sweet, heavy with magic.

I rubbed my temples, the remnants of the dream still clinging to me like cobwebs.

"Note to self," I muttered to the empty room. "I need to configure *Chrono Destinatus* to filter my REM cycle. I'm getting tired of watching my own origin story."